

Day 2

Designing Essay & Critical-Thinking Assessments

Essay and critical-thinking items, model answers, scoring rubrics, and personalised feedback — the whole assessment cycle in one day.

Types of assessment

Essay & critical-thinking items

Step-by-step model answers

Competency rubrics

Scaling personalised feedback

Gathering web evidence

Checking sources & fake citations

Day 2 covers the full assessment cycle for humanities & arts: essay/critical prompts, model answers, rubrics for analysis-critique-creativity, scalable personalized feedback, and source verification.

Date	Tue 21 July 2026
Structure	4 periods · 4 hours (in person)
Level	Applied → Assessment
Participants	Humanities & arts faculty (Tue 21 July 2026)
Instructor	Prof. Jeong Dong-yeop
Practice board	https://padlet.com/aebon/dsu26

Today's Flow

Period	Theme	Learning goal
Period 1 60 min	The Five Faces of Assessment in the Humanities & Arts	Distinguish the characteristics and best uses of essay, critical-thinking, performance, portfolio, and presentation assessments. (Understanding)
Period 2 60 min	Hands-On: Essay Items + Model Answers by Level	Generate essay items for your own course along with model answers at each level. (Applying & Creating)
Period 3 60 min	Building a Rubric That Measures Analysis, Critique, and Creativity	Write a competency-based grading rubric and validate it against your model answers. (Creating & Evaluating)
Period 4 60 min	From One Feedback to All of Them + Verifying Evidence, Sources, and Fake Citations	Turn a sample feedback into a template you can scale, and verify evidence and sources through web search. (Applying & Evaluating)

Replace the **[bracketed]** parts with your own course and topic. Every prompt follows the **[Role]·[Context]·[Request]·[Format]·[Example]·[Condition]** structure.

Period 1 · The Five Faces of Assessment in the Humanities & Arts

Period 1

60 min

Level Foundational

Priority ★★

Learning goal Distinguish the characteristics and best uses of essay, critical-thinking, performance, portfolio, and presentation assessments. (Understanding)

Key content

- ① Essay: explaining what you know in writing — "Explain the meaning of ○○ using two supporting reasons."
- ② Critical: evaluating a claim or a work against evidence — "Identify the weaknesses in this argument and refute them."
- ③ Performance: showing what you can do with your body and hands — recitals, demonstrations, studio production (the heart of the arts)
- ④ Portfolio: a collection that traces a semester of growth — process-centered assessment
- ⑤ Presentation: conveying your thinking out loud — content + delivery + Q&A
- Assessment types and the role of AI: design items and criteria together with AI, but observing performance and making the final judgment stays with the professor
- 📦 Output: A combination chart of assessment types for my own course

Practice — paste straight into Claude

Practice 1 Drawing the assessment blueprint for my course

[Role] You are an expert with 10 years of experience in university assessment design.

[Context] My course is [course name] (undergraduate [year level], [number of students] students), and the current assessment is [current method], which I feel does not really capture what the course is about.

[Request] Among the five types – essay, critical, performance, portfolio, and presentation – recommend the combination that best fits this course.

[Format] Present as a table: (1) the recommended combination and its weighting (2) the competency each assessment measures (3) the preparation work AI can help with for each type.

[Example] A sample combination: "Critical essay 40% + Portfolio 40% + Presentation 20%".

[Condition] Also show the grading burden (time required) so that the combination stays realistic.

Practice 2 Experimenting with a change of type

[Role] You are an education consultant who has worked with many assessment-innovation cases.

[Context] Right now the final assessment in my course is [current method]. In the age of AI, I feel that simply checking memorization is not enough.

[Request] Design what this assessment would look like if I changed it to a combination of critical essay and portfolio.

[Format] A "current → proposed" comparison table + 3 advantages + 3 points to watch out for.

[Example] A sample caution: "A portfolio increases grading time – spread it out with two interim check-ins."

[Condition] Include practical problems such as student pushback or grading burden, along with ways to address them.

Practice 3 Building performance and presentation criteria (arts & physical education)

[Role] You are an expert in designing performance assessments for the arts and physical education.

[Context] I need to assess [name of the performance/presentation task], and I want the criteria to be transparent so that no one misunderstands it as a subjective judgment.

[Request] Create the assessment criteria. For a performance, use three axes – technical accuracy / interpretation and expression / attitude; for a presentation, use three axes – content / delivery / Q&A.

[Format] A table dividing each axis into three levels + an observation checklist the professor can use on the day of the assessment.

[Example] Sample observation items: "□ Maintains tempo in the opening □ Recovers gracefully after a mistake".

[Condition] Assume that observing and judging performance is the professor's responsibility – AI stops at designing the criteria.

Periods 1-2 · Assessment Types + Essay Items & Model Answers

Period 2 · Hands-On: Essay Items + Model Answers by Level

Period 2

60 min

Level Intermediate

Priority ★★★

Learning goal Generate essay items for your own course along with model answers at each level.
(Applying & Creating)

Key content

- What makes a good essay item: **what (the subject) + how (the thinking verb) + conditions (length, number of sources)** must all be clear
- Choosing the thinking verb: summarize (understanding) < compare (analysis) < evaluate (evaluation) < propose (creation)
- "Model answers by level" means: writing weak, adequate, and strong answers in advance so you can see your grading criteria with your own eyes
- Why three model answers are useful: they secure grading consistency and give students concrete examples of each level
- Security principle, revisited: replace real exam items with similar practice items while working in class
- 📦 Output: 2 essay items + a set of model answers at 3 levels

Practice — paste straight into Claude

Practice 1 Designing essay items

[Role] You are an expert with 10 years of experience writing assessment items in [field of study].

[Context] I am preparing an essay assessment that checks the thinking skills of undergraduate [year level] students within the scope of [topic]. (These are practice items, not the real exam items.)

[Request] Create 2 essay items – one analytical ("compare and analyze") and one critical ("evaluate and refute").

[Format] For each item, state the required answer length and number of supporting reasons + a one-line note for the professor on the intent behind the item.

[Example] A sample item format: "Compare and analyze the difference in perspective between the two historical sources (600 characters, at least 2 supporting reasons)."

[Condition] Make sure "what + how (thinking verb) + conditions" all appear within the sentence itself.

Practice 2 Generating model answers at 3 levels

[Role] You are an assessment expert who makes grading criteria visible through sample answers.

[Context] I want to stay consistent when grading item 1 that we just created, and I would also like to show students examples of each level.

[Request] Write the model answer for item 1 at three levels: (1) strong (full marks) (2) adequate (partial credit) (3) weak.

[Format] Under each answer, add 2 lines from a grader's point of view explaining "why this answer sits at this level".

[Example] A sample explanation: "Adequate: grasps the claim, but offers only one supporting reason and shows no awareness of counterarguments."

[Condition] Keep the three answers similar in length – the level should be separated by the quality of thinking, not by word count.

Practice 3 Experimenting with difficulty adjustment

[Role] You are an assessment designer who fine-tunes item difficulty with precision.

[Context] I like item 1, and I would like to adapt it for classes at other year levels as well.

[Request] Adapt item 1 into (1) a version one step easier (for first-year students) and (2) a version one step harder (advanced, for third- and fourth-year students).

[Format] A three-column table: "Version / Item / What was changed (thinking verb, conditions, source material)".

[Example] A sample principle of adjustment: "Easier version – change 'compare' to 'identify two differences' and provide the source material."

[Condition] Explain the principle behind why the difficulty changed, so that I can apply it to other items on my own.

Periods 3-4 · Competency Rubrics + Scalable Feedback + Source Verification

Period 3 · Building a Rubric That Measures Analysis, Critique, and Creativity

Period 3

60 min

Level Advanced

Priority ★★★

Learning goal Write a competency-based grading rubric and validate it against your model answers.
(Creating & Evaluating)

Key content

- A **competency rubric** = a criteria table that measures **not knowledge, but "the quality of thinking"**
- Breaking down the three core competencies: analysis (grasping structure, finding relationships) / critique (evaluating evidence, counterarguments) / creativity (making new connections, proposing alternatives)
- How to describe levels: instead of vague words like "does well," **describe behavior, as in "constructs a counterargument using at least two supporting reasons"**
- How to validate a rubric: grade the three model answers from period 2 with the rubric and check whether the scores come out as expected
- Applying it in the arts: a performance rubric (technical accuracy / interpretation and expression / creativity) is built the same way
- 📦 Output: 1 competency rubric (validated)

Practice — paste straight into Claude

Practice 1 Generating a competency rubric

[Role] You are an expert with 10 years of experience designing educational assessment rubrics.

[Context] I need to grade [name of the assignment/item]. I want to measure the quality of thinking (analysis, critique, creativity) fairly, rather than memorized knowledge.

[Request] Create a grading rubric.

[Format] A table of 4 criteria (analytical skill / critical thinking / creativity / expression) × 4 levels (weak, 1 point, through outstanding, 4 points).

[Example] Sample wording for the outstanding cell: "Constructs a counterargument using at least two supporting reasons, and even acknowledges the limits of their own counterargument."

[Condition] No vague wording such as "does well" in any cell – describe it so that the student's concrete behavior is visible. Below the table, add 3 common mistakes made during grading.

Practice 2 Validating the rubric with model answers

[Role] You are a quality reviewer who tests whether a rubric actually works.

[Context] I want to check whether the rubric we just created really separates the levels.

[Request] Using this rubric, grade each of the three model answers we made earlier (strong / adequate / weak).

[Format] A table with "Criterion / Strong answer: score and reasoning / Adequate answer: score and reasoning / Weak answer: score and reasoning" + a comparison of total scores.

[Example] A sample verdict: "Total scores – strong 14 / adequate 9 / weak 5 – the levels separate successfully."

[Condition] If there is a criterion where the total scores do not spread apart well, revise the level descriptions for that criterion and show me the result again.

Practice 3 Creating a student-facing version of the rubric

[Role] You are a communication expert who translates assessment criteria into students' own language.

[Context] I plan to share the validated rubric with students along with the assignment instructions. I want publishing the criteria to double as guidance for learning.

[Request] Turn this rubric into a version meant for students.

[Format] Rewrite the top level of each criterion around examples, in the spirit of "an answer that does this is a good answer" + a 5-question self-check list to use before submitting.

[Example] A sample check item: "□ Did I write even one sentence about what someone who disagrees with my claim might say?"

[Condition] Use the words students actually use rather than assessment jargon, and keep it within one A4 page.

Periods 3-4 · Competency Rubrics + Scalable Feedback + Source Verification

Period 4 · From One Feedback to All of Them + Verifying Evidence, Sources, and Fake Citations

Period 4

60 min

Level Intermediate

Priority ★★★

Learning goal Turn a sample feedback into a template you can scale, and verify evidence and sources through web search. (Applying & Evaluating)

Key content

- A strategy for personalized feedback: write one carefully crafted sample → extract its structure as a template → apply it to each student by changing only the individual notes
- The three-part structure of feedback: what went well (with a specific quotation) → where to grow (including the method) → encouragement toward the next step
- Privacy principle, revisited: remove student names and ID numbers, and enter only the minimum necessary from the assignment content
- **Catching fake citations (hallucinated references):** always confirm whether a reference produced by AI actually exists — search the title, author, and year
- **Gathering evidence through web search:** collect recent cases and statistics for your items and feedback via web search, and record the source along with them
- A 5-step verification routine: ① tag every citation as "unverified" → ② search the title exactly as written (Google Scholar, RISS, DBpia) → ③ check against the original text → ④ delete anything you cannot find → ⑤ cite only what you have confirmed

- Teach it to students too: add "when using AI, indicate whether the original text of every citation was checked" to your assignment requirements
- 📦 Output: A feedback template + a source verification checklist

Practice — paste straight into Claude

Practice 1 From a sample feedback to a scalable template

[Role] You are an education coach who analyzes the structure of good feedback.

[Context] Below is feedback I wrote carefully for the essay of student A (anonymized). I would like to extend this same quality to all 30 students.

[Request] Analyze the structure of this feedback and turn it into a template I can use for other students as well.

[Format] The template (leave the parts that change per student as [blanks], and keep the fixed frame as is) + 3 lines on how to use it.

[Example] A sample template sentence: "Your [strength] stands out in [specific quotation]. Next time, try [method]."

[Condition] Preserve my tone of voice, and leave the closing encouragement slot empty, marked "write this yourself".

[Paste the sample feedback here]

Practice 2 Training to hunt down fake citations

[Role] You are an academic librarian who verifies whether references really exist.

[Context] Some material generated by AI came with a reference list attached. Because fake citations are fatal in humanities and social science writing, I want to check them one by one.

[Request] Search the web and confirm whether the following references actually exist: [reference list]

[Format] A table with "Reference / Exists? / Link to the source consulted / Accuracy of author, year, and title".

[Example] Sample verdicts: "○○ (2021) – no search results, deletion recommended / △△ (2019) – exists, but the correct year is 2018."

[Condition] Mark any reference you cannot confirm as "deletion recommended", and remind me that the final judgment requires me to open the original text myself.

Practice 3 Collecting and verifying evidence through web search

[Role] You are a meticulous academic researcher who always leaves the source behind.

[Context] I need recent supporting material (cases, statistics, research) for the essay assessments and feedback in [course name]. I cannot use anything whose source is unclear.

[Request] Search the web and find 3 pieces of supporting material on [topic] published within the last 2 years.

[Format] For each item, present in a table: (1) a one-line summary (2) the source (institution, publication date, link) (3) how to use it in assessment or feedback (4) the items I should verify myself in the original text.

[Example] A sample use: "As the source material for an essay item – have students interpret this statistic and build an argument from it."

[Condition] Exclude entirely any material whose source cannot be confirmed, and if you find fewer than 3, tell me how you changed the search terms and tried again.

Practice 4 Varying feedback by student type

[Role] You are a professor with a counselor's instincts, attentive even to a student's state of mind.

[Context] The same feedback template has to land differently depending on where a student is.

[Request] Adapt my feedback template for three student types: (1) a student who does well but has grown complacent – offer a challenge (2) a student who works hard but does not know how – give concrete methods (3) a student who has lost confidence – help them rediscover their strengths.

[Format] One sample feedback for each type (within 5 lines).

[Example] A sample sentence for the rediscovering-strengths type: "The metaphor in this paragraph was the freshest in the class – try bringing that instinct into your main argument as well."

[Condition] Assume the same assignment situation for all three so that the differences stand out clearly.

Notes — what I made today / what I will use in my course
